

Week 2 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, September 9–12, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 2

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray’s Arithmetic, next lesson, 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: I know a little cupboard

Recitation: Genesis 1:1
In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

Hymn: first stanza of “I Bind Unto Myself Today”

Folk song: “The Bold Grenadier” — preview lyrics

Math: next Ray’s lesson. One sitting. Oral first when the book allows.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 9	Exodus 4	Island Story ch. 23, Stamford Bridge	Nature sit · “The Cupboard” · hymn
Thu 10	Exodus 5	Little Duke, ch. 1 second half	Burgess Animal Book ch. 2 · folk song
Fri 11	Exodus 6 (omit 14–25)	CHOW, two emperors / Charlemagne	Map + compass · Rockwell · hymn
Sat 12	Luke 19:10–27	Understood Betsy ch. 1	Pilgrim’s Progress · Bernstein · evening walk

Books to have open

- Bible
- Ray’s Arithmetic
- Our Island Story*, ch. 23
- The Little Duke*, finish ch. 1
- Hillyer, *A Child’s History of the World* (first sitting)
- Burgess Animal Book*, ch. 2
- Understood Betsy*, ch. 1
- de la Mare, “The Cupboard” in *Peacock Pie*
- Cheap compass · England / Europe map · nature notebook

Skip *Tree in the Trail* ch. 2–3 (not PD) and *Trial and Triumph* (not on this week’s list).

Two children

The 2nd grader does the whole morning. The preschooler joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, and outside. During math, copywork, and heavier history they play nearby with quiet work.

Heat

Bastrop in September. Outside at 8am or after 6pm. Not midday. Times on the day pages slide; keep the order.

New this week

First CHOW sitting (Charlemagne). First *Understood Betsy*. Finish Little Duke ch. 1. Do not stack Island Story and CHOW.

Free sources

Island Story: archive.org · Little Duke: Gutenberg 3048 · CHOW 1924: Gutenberg 67149 · Burgess: 2441 · Understood Betsy: 5347 · “The Cupboard” in Peacock Pie: 3753 · PP: 131.

When Children Love to Learn

Elaine Cooper, ed. This week: Chapter 2, “The Child is a Person.” Read it once. Do not take notes for a quiz. Let it change how you sit with them.

THIS WEEK’S READING

Chapter 2 · The Child is a Person. About twenty minutes, sometime before Wednesday school. Not during the children’s lessons.

What to do with it

The 2nd grader is a person who can tell a story back.
The preschooler is a person too, not a lesson to finish.
After you read Cooper’s chapter, watch for one moment this week when you almost prompt, bribe, or rush. Stop. Wait.

In the lessons

Narration is how a person shows they know. Read once. Close the book. Let them talk. Do not turn Little Duke or Understood Betsy into a questionnaire. If they give three true sentences, that is enough.

What not to do

No stickers for finishing math. No “and then what?” while they narrate. No comparing the 2nd grader to anyone. Ray’s is still one lesson. Stop while they are still with you.

Mason’s student motto, if you want it on the wall

I am, I ought, I can, I will. For a child: I am a child of God. I ought to do His will. I can do what He tells me. By His grace, I will. Say it once this week if it fits. Do not drill it.

Coming weeks in this book

Week 3: Chapter 3, Atmosphere.
Week 4: Chapter 3, Discipline (habits).
Week 5: Chapter 3, Life (ideas, not stuffing).
Week 6: Chapter 3, Science of Relations.
Then Chapter 4, one distinctive at a time (living books, narration, nature, and the rest).

If you only do one thing

Read the chapter. On Thursday, after Little Duke, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. That is the lesson for you.

This page is original notes pointing to your book. It is not a reprint of Cooper.

How to teach this week

Same habits as week 1. New books, new stop-points. You are not a textbook.

01 Narration is still the lesson

Read once, close the book, let the child tell it back. Do not interrupt. Do not prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank them. Do not grade it. This week they will narrate a battle, a father’s visit, a new history book, and a new American story. One reading at a time.

02 Do not stack two histories

Island Story (Wednesday) is England, 1066. CHOW (Friday) is Charlemagne, about 800. They belong on different days. If you miss Wednesday, do Stamford Bridge Thursday and slide Little Duke — do not put both histories in one morning.

03 Copywork, a new line

Week 1 was the moon line from “Silver.” This week: *I know a little cupboard*, from de la Mare’s “The Cupboard.” Show the line. Best handwriting. Then stop. If the hand tires, fewer words tomorrow.

04 Recitation, keep the verse

Genesis 1:1 together, then they try. When it is solid, add the first two lines of “The Cupboard.” Do not drop the verse to start the poem. A poem learned by heart is a gift, not a test.

05 Ray’s Arithmetic

Next lesson. No numbers from me. Oral first when the book allows. If they miss two in a row, stop and try those tomorrow. Preschooler: quiet work in the same room.

06 Bible without a sermon

Exodus 4–6 is heavier than week 1. Moses still objects. Pharaoh makes the work worse. Skip the name-list in 6:14–25. Read, narrate, one true sentence, stop. Saturday’s parable is for both children. It is the minas (gold coins), not Matthew’s talents.

07 Two children in one room

Preschooler sits for living stories, songs, poems, Burgess, picture study, and nature. They are not expected to narrate Stamford Bridge or Charlemagne. During math, copywork, and CHOW, give them quiet work: blocks, crayons, playdough, a basket of pinecones. If they melt, send them outside and keep going with the 2nd grader.

08 Stamford Bridge follows Harold

Week 1 ended with Harold king. This chapter is the north: Tostig, the Norwegian king, the fight at the bridge, then news that William has landed in the south. **Do not read Hastings** (ch. 24, next week). Narration: who came, what happened at the bridge, what news came after. Timeline: Stamford Bridge, 1066.

09 Finish Little Duke chapter 1

Week 1 was the boy, Bayeux, the castle. This sitting is the father’s visit: reading, forgiving enemies, the silver key, then William rides away. Finish the chapter. **Do not open chapter 2** (the messengers). That is next week. Gutenberg 3048 if you need the text.

10 First CHOW sitting

AO week 2 is later-edition **ch. 47 “Two Empires, Two Emperors.”** The 1924 Gutenberg text numbers the same Charlemagne chapter as **ch. 45 “A Light in the Dark Ages.”** Use whichever matches the book in your hand. Cap at 20 minutes. This is France and the year 800, not England. Place “Charlemagne, about 800” on the timeline — more than a hundred years before Harold.

How to teach this week

New books. Same short lessons. Stop while they still want more.

11 Understood Betsy is long

Chapter 1, “Aunt Harriet Has a Cough,” is the first sitting of this book and it runs long. Stop at twenty minutes even if they beg. Narrate who Elizabeth Ann lives with, and what went wrong. If the chapter is not done, a second 15-minute sitting after Saturday’s notebook. Finish ch. 1 this week; week 3 is ch. 2. Gutenberg 5347.

12 Pilgrim’s Progress, still gentle

Official AO week 2 is the rest of the verse Apology. Last week you skipped that for a simple overview. Stay on that path: the dream-picture of a man in rags, a book, a burden, “What shall I do?” Then stop. Evangelist waits. If you would rather match AO’s 72-week text exactly, read the rest of the Apology instead and save the dream for week 3.

13 Burgess is the easy science

Chapter 2: Peter and Jumper go to school. Cottontail and hare, snowshoe feet, a cousin who swims. Both children. Narrate one true difference between Peter and Jumper. That is the whole lesson. No classification chart.

14 Nature is still looking

Lost Pines, early September, heat. One invertebrate: an orb web at 8am, a cicada shell on a loblolly, ants, a cricket at dusk, a millipede under bark if it has rained. Watch for fire ants. Names only if they ask. Saturday evening is the longer hunt.

15 Picture study, second look

Same Rockwell: *Freedom of Speech*. Four quiet minutes. Turn it over. They tell what was in the picture, then one thing they did not say last week. Look again. Library book or museum image. Do not print a packet. Copyright still holds; looking is the lesson.

16 Map, then compass

Term geography is still the compass. This week also place two stories: York and the North Sea (Stamford Bridge); France or Aachen (Charlemagne). Hide the compass. Let the 2nd grader point north. Preschooler plays “find north.” No worksheet.

17 Music, same excerpt

Bernstein’s *Jeremiah* again, five to eight minutes while they draw. Familiarity comes from hearing, not from explaining. No quiz. Legal stream or library recording.

18 If it falls apart

Skip to outdoor time. Pick up tomorrow. A song and a walk still count as school. If you must cut a day, keep Bible, Ray’s, and that day’s main reading. Riches can wait.

19 Folk song caution

Still preview “The Bold Grenadier.” Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Hymn: only the first stanza of the Breastplate this month.

20 What you are skipping

Tree in the Trail ch. 2–3 is on AO’s week 2 list and is not public domain. Skip it unless the book is already in the house. *Trial and Triumph* is not assigned this week. Shakespeare is not on this week’s list unless a leftover page from week 1 is marked.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn words · Ray's · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 23 · "The Cupboard" · nature notebook

8:00 **Nature sit** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Backyard or porch. Twenty minutes. One thing only: an orb web in morning light, a cicada shell on a loblolly pine, ants on the path, or a grasshopper. Look. Do not name everything. Sketch if they want. This drawing comes back on Saturday.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 4**

God Calls Moses. Staff, the hand, Aaron as mouth, Moses turns toward Egypt. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. One true sentence if needed: God does not send Moses alone. Then stop.

8:40 **Hymn** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (St. Patrick's Breastplate). Still only the opening this month. Sing. Do not explain it to death.

8:50 **Ray's Arithmetic**

Next lesson, 15–20 min. Oral first if the book allows. Stop while attention is still on. Preschooler: quiet work nearby.

9:10 **Copywork & recitation**

Copy: *I know a little cupboard*. Best handwriting, then stop. Recite Genesis 1:1 together, then they try.

9:25 **History · *Our Island Story*, ch. 23**

"The Battle of Stamford Bridge." Last week Harold was king. This week the north. Stop at 20 minutes. Do not start Hastings. Narrate: who came to fight Harold, what happened at the bridge, what news came after. Place "Stamford Bridge, 1066" on the timeline.

9:50 **Movement, then poem** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Run around the house or stretch. Then read de la Mare's "The Cupboard" once. No talk after unless they start it. Books done about 10:10. Free play.

If the morning slips, keep Bible, Ray's, Stamford Bridge, and the nature sit. Drop the hymn and poem to tomorrow.

How to teach Wednesday

A battle chapter and a cupboard poem in the same morning is the point. Variety, then stop.

Exodus 4 — God Calls Moses

Week 1 ended at the bush. Today Moses still does not want to go. Signs are given. Aaron will speak. They turn toward Egypt. Read the chapter once. Close the book. Let the 2nd grader tell it. If they stall, wait. One sentence from you is enough: God does not send him alone. The preschooler may only hold “a stick that became a snake.” That is fine. Do not unpack every name of God.

Island Story, ch. 23 — Stamford Bridge

Connect last week in one sentence before you open the book: “Harold is king. Now trouble comes from the north.” Then read. Do not lecture 1066.

What the child needs to hold, in their own words:

- Who came to fight Harold (his brother Tostig and a king from Norway).
- Harold marched north, fast.
- There was a fight at a bridge.
- Then news from the south: another enemy had landed.

Stop here. Do not read chapter 24, “The Battle of Hastings.” That is next week. If the chapter runs long, stop at twenty minutes even mid-page and finish Thursday before Little Duke — still do not start Hastings.

Timeline: write or place “Stamford Bridge, 1066.” Map, if you have one: York, the Humber, the North Sea. William’s ships wait until Friday’s map or next week. Archive.org: *An island story* (Stokes, 1906).

“The Cupboard”

From *Peacock Pie*, 1913. Both children. Read it once after they have run around. It is domestic and funny after a battle. That is the variety. No talk unless they start it. Copywork all week is the first line: *I know a little cupboard*. Gutenberg 3753.

Nature sit — Lost Pines heat

Eight o’clock, not later. One invertebrate or one web. Orb webs show in morning light between yaupon or porch rails. Cicada shells still cling to loblolly bark. Ants on the path. Look. The drawing waits for Saturday. Watch for fire ants; do not stand in them.

Preschooler: nature, Bible (as they will sit), hymn, poem. Quiet work through Ray’s and copywork. They may listen to Island Story if they will be still; they need not narrate it.

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song (previewed) · Ray's · *The Little Duke* · *Burgess Animal Book* ch. 2

8:00 **Short yard time** OPTIONAL

Ten minutes if Wednesday's sit went well. Or skip and save the long walk for Saturday evening.

8:20 **Bible · Exodus 5** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Bricks without straw. Pharaoh will not let them go; the work gets harder. Read once. Narrate. Do not turn it into a lecture. The preschooler will hold "more bricks"; the 2nd grader should hold the whole thread.

8:35 **Folk song**

"The Bold Grenadier," also sung as "One Morning in May." Preview the lyrics first. Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Both children.

8:45 **Ray's, copywork, recitation**

Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: *I know a little cupboard*. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. If the verse is sticking, add the first two lines of "The Cupboard" at the end of the morning.

9:20 **Tales · *The Little Duke*, ch. 1 second half**

Week 1 stopped after the boy and the castle. This sitting: Duke William's visit, the talk about reading and forgiving enemies, the silver key, father rides away. Finish the chapter. Do not start chapter 2. Narrate. Gutenberg 3048.

9:50 **Natural history · Burgess ch. 2** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

"Peter and Jumper Go To School." Both children. The easy living-science of the week. Narrate one true difference between Peter and Jumper.

10:10 **Done**

Books finished. If anyone is still bright, reread "The Cupboard." Do not add another chapter.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray's, Little Duke, and Burgess. Folk song can wait for Saturday.

How to teach Thursday

Finish a chapter. Start a school in the Green Forest. Do not open the next door.

Exodus 5 — bricks without straw

Moses and Aaron go to Pharaoh. The answer is more work, not less. The people turn on Moses. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. This is a hard chapter. You do not need to explain providence. One true sentence if the child is distressed: the story is not over. Then stop.

Little Duke — second half of chapter 1

Open where you marked last week. If you are not sure, the second half is the father's visit: the feast, the private talk (letters, English kings, forgiving enemies), the silver key on a chain, then morning and Duke William riding away.

Stop at the end of chapter 1. Do not start chapter 2. The messengers, and what they bring, belong to next week. If they beg, say the next part keeps. That is the method.

Narration: what Richard and his father talked about, and how the visit ended. If they only remember the hunt or the key, that is still a narration. Do not prompt the forgiveness talk unless they found it themselves. Gutenberg 3048.

Burgess ch. 2 — Peter and Jumper go to school

Old Mother Nature asks Peter what he looks like, where he lives, what he eats. Then Jumper. Snowshoe feet. A cousin in the south who likes water. Both children sit for this. It is the living science, not a textbook.

Narrate one true difference between Peter and Jumper (ears, feet, winter coat, holes in the ground). If they also remember the swimming cousin, good. No chart. No "rodent" lecture — that comes later in the book and is not this week's work. Gutenberg 2441.

Folk song

Same clean set as last week. Preview again if you switched recordings. Five minutes. Both children. If anyone is wriggly after Exodus, sing before math, as written.

Preschooler: Bible as they will sit, folk song, Burgess. Quiet work through Ray's, copywork, and Little Duke. Little Duke is a tale, so they may listen if they will be still; they need not narrate Richard's talk with his father.

Friday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn · Ray's · Hillyer (or Synge) · cheap compass · simple map of England and western Europe · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

8:20

Bible · Exodus 6

God repeats the promise. Moses is still discouraged. **Omit verses 14–25** (the family list). Read once. Narrate. You do not need to unpack every name of God today.

8:35

Hymn, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Same stanza as Wednesday. Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the cupboard line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. Preschooler: quiet work through math and copywork, then they may come for map and picture study.

9:20

World history · CHOW, Charlemagne

Later printings: ch. 47 "Two Empires, Two Emperors." 1924 Gutenberg: ch. 45 "A Light in the Dark Ages." Same sitting. Two emperors, about the year 800. Cap at 20 minutes. Narrate who Charlemagne was. This is not England. Do not mash it into Stamford Bridge.

9:50

Map, then compass PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Point: York and the North Sea (Wednesday's battle). Point: France or Aachen (Charlemagne). Then the compass. Hide it. Let the 2nd grader find north. Preschooler plays "find north." No worksheet.

10:10

Picture study · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

Second look at the same painting. Look four minutes in silence. Turn it over. Child tells what was there, then one new thing they did not say last week. Look once more. Library book or a museum image on a screen. Do not print a packet.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray's, CHOW, and picture study. Map can be a five-minute point-and-name after CHOW.

How to teach Friday

A new history book. Match the chapter to the copy in your hand. Then look at the painting again.

Exodus 6 — skip the names

Read 6:1–13, skip 14–25, finish the chapter if you want the last promises. The middle is a genealogy. AO says you may omit it. Omit it. Narrate: God tells Moses again that He will bring the people out; Moses still does not see how. One sentence, then stop.

Which CHOW chapter?

AO's week 2 line is: *Child's History of the World* ch. 47 "Two Empires, Two Emperors" (ch. 45 "Light in the Dark Ages" in 1st ed.).

- If your book's contents list **Two Empires, Two Emperors** as chapter 47, read that.
- If you are on Gutenberg 67149 or another 1924 text, read **chapter 45, "A Light in the Dark Ages."**
- If you do not have Hillyer, AO's other options are Synge, *Discovery of New Worlds* ch. 12 "The Dark Ages," or van Loon ch. 29 Charlemagne. One of these, not all of them.

The sitting is Charlemagne and two empires, about the year 800. Read once. Cap at 20 minutes. Narrate who Charlemagne was, and what "two emperors" means in the child's words. Timeline: "Charlemagne, about 800." That is more than a hundred years before Harold. Say so once, on the timeline, not as a quiz.

Do not mash this into Wednesday. Stamford Bridge is England, 1066. CHOW today is the continent, about 800. Two pictures, two days.

1924 text: Gutenberg 67149. AO chapter list: amblesideonline.org/contents-chow-sotw.

Map and compass

Term work is still the compass (needle north; N S E W; sailors). This week's stories give you two places to point before you hide the compass: York / North Sea, and France or Aachen. Then go outside if the heat allows, or stand at the door. Preschooler: "find north." No worksheet. If CHOW ran long, do only the two points on the map and skip the compass review.

Picture study — second look

Same painting as last Friday: Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*. Look four minutes. Turn it over. They tell what they remember, then one thing they did not say last week. Look again. That is the whole lesson. No art-history talk. Copyright still holds; looking is the lesson.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song · Ray's · *Understood Betsy* · a simple way to tell Pilgrim's Progress · Bernstein excerpt · nature notebook · evening walk plan

8:20 Bible · Luke 19:10–27 PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Last week was Zacchaeus. This week starts with the seeking sentence, then the parable of the gold coins (minas). A nobleman, servants, one who hid the coin. Read once. Narrate the story. Do not allegorize.

8:35 Folk song, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Clean verses of "The Bold Grenadier." Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the cupboard line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1, and "The Cupboard" if it has begun to stick.

9:20 Literature · *Understood Betsy*, ch. 1

"Aunt Harriet Has a Cough." First sitting of this book. The chapter is long. Stop at 20 minutes. Narrate who Elizabeth Ann lives with, and what went wrong. If unfinished, a second sitting after the notebook. Gutenberg 5347.

9:45 Literature · *Pilgrim's Progress*, continued

Still the gentle path, not the Apology. The dream-picture: a man in rags, a book, a burden on his back, "What shall I do?" Then stop. Narrate the picture. Evangelist waits.

10:00 Composer and notebook PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Five to eight minutes of Bernstein's *Jeremiah* while they draw Wednesday's web, shell, or ant. You may scribe one sentence they say, dated. Legal stream. No quiz. Keep the drawing to twenty minutes.

After 6 Evening walk · Lost Pines or a creek

Bastrop heat. Not midday. Prompt: find one invertebrate (orb-weaver, cricket, ant, millipede, cicada shell). Look. Watch for fire ants. Draw later only if they ask. A song on the way home still counts.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray's, *Understood Betsy*, and the evening walk. PP and Bernstein can be five minutes each, or wait.

How to teach Saturday

A new American story, a small piece of the dream, then heat-wise outdoor time.

Luke 19:10–27 — the gold coins

Last week ended with Zacchaeus. Verse 10 belongs to that scene, then the parable. AO calls it the Parable of the Gold Coin. It is the minas (or pounds), not the talents in Matthew 25. A nobleman goes away. Servants receive money to use. One hides his in a napkin. Read once. Both children. Narrate the story as a story. Do not turn the coins into a sermon on gifts. If the preschooler only holds “a man who hid his coin,” that is enough.

Understood Betsy, ch. 1

Dorothy Canfield Fisher, 1916. Public domain. Gutenberg 5347. Elizabeth Ann lives with Great-aunt Harriet and Aunt Frances, who “understand” her so carefully she is afraid of almost everything. A doctor comes for the child and hears Aunt Harriet cough. Plans change. The child may have to leave.

Stop at twenty minutes even if they beg. This chapter is longer than Island Story. If you are not done, take a second 15-minute sitting after the nature notebook and finish ch. 1 today. Week 3 is ch. 2, “Betsy Holds the Reins.” Do not start it.

Narration: who Elizabeth Ann lives with, and what went wrong. Do not explain the moral (overprotection, Vermont, self-reliance). The book will do that. The preschooler may listen if they will sit; they need not narrate.

Pilgrim’s Progress — the dream-picture

Week 1 told the frame: a man named Christian traveling to the Celestial City. This week give the first picture from the dream, then stop: rags, a book, a burden, “What shall I do?” You may read that opening from Bunyan (Gutenberg 131) or tell it in a few sentences. Narrate the picture. Do not read the verse Apology unless you have decided to match AO’s 72-week text exactly. Evangelist, the wicket-gate, and the City of Destruction by name can wait. Both children may hear this; keep it short.

Bernstein and the notebook

Same excerpt as last Saturday is fine. Five to eight minutes while they draw. You may scribe one dated sentence. Stop while the drawing still pleases them. Hearing it twice in two weeks is the lesson.

Evening walk — invertebrates, after 6

Lost Pines or a creek edge. Still hot in Bastrop at midday. Prompt: one invertebrate. Orb-weaver in porch light or between pines, cricket, katydid, ant, millipede under bark if it has rained, cicada shell still on a loblolly. Look. Not a field-guide test. Watch for fire ants. A song on the way home still counts. Week 2 is done when the walk is done.